

Web watch

Summer's here and well-established entities and new ventures alike are heating up the online space

Security watch

We take a look at the latest developments in the world of data and information security

Rumor has it...

The rumour mill is constantly cranking out stories about tech and gadgets. We're here to tell you that they may be true, as leaks suggest

Nokia's budget phones X2 may feature Qualcomm MSM8210 processor, XL for sale at Rs.12k

Details about Nokia's next X-series smartphone, dubbed the X2, have surfaced online. The Nokia X2 is expected to feature improved hardware specs as compared to its predecessors, X and XL.

According to a leaked benchmark result, the Nokia X2 will be powered by a Qualcomm MSM8210 processor. Moreover, the smartphone will have 1 GB of RAM and 4 GB of internal space. The Nokia X2 manages a score of 11,827 – considered to be good for a low cost handset. As per older rumours, the smartphone will feature a dedicated home button as well.

After having built a lot of buzz, Nokia's Android-based X smartphone failed to win critics, mainly because of its poor specs as well as sluggish UI and Android customisation.

That said, Nokia seems to be more focused in the specs department with the new X2. There are already speculations that the phone is set to compete against a wide range of budget Android smartphones, including the newly launched, low cost Moto E.

While speaking of the X2, its predecessor Nokia XL comes to mind, which is now up for grabs via the company's official store for Rs. 11,489. Currently, the Nokia store has a green variant listed and promises to deliver within five working days.



The Nokia XL

The Nokia XL is a dual SIM smartphone, featuring a 5-inch IPS display with 800x480 resolution and 233ppi. The XL is based on customised Android 4.1 with Fastlane and is powered by a 1GHz dual-core Qualcomm MSM8225 Snapdragon S4 processor along with 768 MB of RAM.

The XL has a 5MP rear camera with auto-focus and LED flash and 2MP front-facing camera. The smartphone comes with 4GB storage, expandable via microSD. It's powered by a 2,000mAh battery.

Google may replace Nexus line with Android Silver, teams with HTC for tablet

Rumours about Google abandoning its popular Nexus series resurfaced on the web in May. According to phone leaks expert @evleaks, Google won't be announcing a Nexus 6 at its forthcoming Google I/O event. New rumours reiterate that the Nexus will be replaced by a new project called "Android Silver" by 2015. An LG handset, run-

ning on a Qualcomm MSM8994 processor, is rumoured to be among the first Silver devices.

"There is no Nexus 6. Farewell, Nexus. Don't worry, there's a silver lining to this cloud... Android Silver, circa February 2015," said Evleaks in a series of tweets in May.

At the time of writing, there's not much information available about Google's new initiative, though a recent report in *The Information* suggests Google will be using Android Silver to expand its influence in the Android eco-system.

The report further states that Google will be subsidising the development and marketing



Silver linings?

expenses for its hardware partners. The search engine giant is reportedly spending about \$1 billion to roll out its plan. LG and Motorola are believed to be the most likely hardware partners for Google's new range of devices. Sony, HTC and Samsung are expected to join later.

Google reportedly teams up with HTC for 3rd gen Nexus tablet

In another partnership, Google will be teaming up with HTC to launch the next Nexus tablet, if a report by *DigiTimes* is to be

believed. According to the site, Taiwanese component manufacturers have received orders for 8-inch HTC devices, expected to be launched with the Google Nexus brand.

Considering that the Nexus has already helped Google boost Android in the tablet space, the company is expected to not aggressively market its third-generation Nexus. Moreover, Google is no longer keen on staying in the tablet market and the third-gen Nexus could be the last tablet from the search engine giant.

The device is expected to be showcased at Google's annual I/O Developers Conference on June 25 and June 2. Earlier rumours hinted at the unveiling of the Nexus 8 and new Android iteration v4.5 at the event.

If the report turns out to be true, HTC will replace Asus as the Nexus manufacturer. Asus had manufactured the first and second generation Nexus tablets. It's worth pointing out here that Google had first approached HTC for a joint venture on the Nexus slates. HTC, however, turned down the offer as it was focusing on its smartphone business at the time.

Moreover, Asus is now focusing on its own smartphones and tablets business. *DigiTimes* reports that Asus "has also not been as aggressive over third-generation Nexus orders since Google has placed restrictions on the partnership and Asustek would have no initiative during the development."